Session 57

2026-11-08

1 - An odd pendant

~13:20, 17 Hammer 1490 DR

1. Combing **Trepsin**'s cooling pyre, Mialee lifts a small object the troll had carried in a pocket — a pendant that settles in her palm with the odd familiarity of something she might have seen before. She tucks it aside for Amidamaru to identify later.
2. Mialee walks over to **Sohey** and offers the words she can for his fallen. The goblin keeps tally: thirty-six warriors lost to the butcher over the last months, counting these two. *"Tonight, after we see our friends off, we feast."*
3. The Nashkag build a smaller pyre for Trepsin's bones; one of them fits the troll's skull over his own head as a vast, crooked helmet and begins to dance. Their own two dead they carry away uncremated.
4. Sohey tells them to wait and bolts north — a speed none of them have ever seen on anything living, air pulling at their faces as he passes.
5. The other goblins drift off in every compass direction, grinning when Mialee asks where their village lies.

2 - Sticky rope

~14:00, 17 Hammer 1490 DR

1. Forty minutes later Sohey staggers back from the west, soaked in sweat and barely able to pull air — a man who had fought Trepsin without ever losing his breath. He lays a cloth bundle at their feet and gives back each item one of theirs had been robbed of: Eguzkilore's waterskin, Nuberroca's rations and Nyx's magical rope.
2. The returned rope sits tacky in Nyx's palm — the halfling frowns at it, puzzled, as if she were no longer sure it were truly hers. Then she pauses over the pendant Mialee had found and notes it is close kin to the one already at her own throat.
3. From his pack he draws two items and offers one each to Mialee and Eguzkilore — Sohey has heard they are good at drawing words — a pair of spectacles and a beautiful pen, both carrying the weight of magic under the touch. Mialee takes the glasses; Eguzkilore the pen.
4. Mialee asks him for some evidence the cultists might accept that they have found their village, and one or two days of inactivity so **Talis** will believe the extermination is done. Sohey agrees and, after catching breath for a few seconds and complaining of his luck, runs again, east this time.

3 - A painful itch

1. Eguzkilore pleads with Sinsong for a touch of healing and shows him the ache on his chest. Sinsong lays a hand there and begins the spell — as the magic reaches in, a red welt the size of a fist blooms where the cleric touches, then rapid-blooming blisters crawl across his chest faster than he can refuse to scratch.
2. Reading the condition as some kind of curse, Sinsong sits Eguzkilore down with his back turned, lays a hand on his head, and begins to weave the counter-magic. As its threads draw close a lock of hair drops and fresh blisters bloom across the elf's scalp; the cleric presses on regardless, waving off Mialee's dry question about his cosmetic intentions and admitting with a grin that he rather likes the look.
3. After a long moment Sinsong remembers the old tales: certain people's flesh simply rejects the touch of magic, convulsing or killing them outright under enough of it. The affliction's origin was never traced, it did not spread from one sufferer to the next, and the symptoms cleared on their own after about a week — though some forms of healing still worked on them, despite the agony of first contact.
4. Sinsong retreats behind a tree and sends a disembodied hand onto Eguzkilore's scalp. The earlier welts on his chest and head fade on their own as the new magic lands; fresh blisters rise where the hand touches, and a few more locks of hair drop. Half-bald and stinging, Eguzkilore chases Sinsong down and hauls him up by the collar: *"¿Y ahora cómo voy a liǵar?"*

4 – Rum and powder

~15:00, 17 Hammer 1490 DR

1. Sohey returns from the south with a carved wooden totem almost as large as he is balanced on one shoulder, and lays it in the snow. *"The tribe's totem. Proof you have been to our settlement. These are our gods and our ancestors. Treat it carefully."*
2. Nuberroca turns to Sohey and asks the goblin to train him in some of his techniques, offering to stay behind for a couple of days while the others report him as another combat casualty to sweeten the lie. Sohey shrugs and accepts — though Sinsong and Mialee, already laying bets on the outcome, insist the first lesson happen there and then, in front of them.
3. ***[EPIC]*** Nuberroca opens with his polearm in a raging charge; despite an impossible dodge, the spear grazes Sohey's cheek and draws a single bead of blood. Sohey's eyes widen — *"Oh? You're good."* Then the goblin dances: he slips the killing stroke that should have finished him, counters with Nuberroca's own spear-shaft driven into the goliath's flank, and reads him minute by minute until Sinsong calls it off with the barbarian nearly spent.
4. Sinsong gathers the party into a circle around him and heals them all without incident — Eguzkilore stays well back. The cleric then runs over to the elf and lays a hand on him anyway; the healing takes, but the rash flares across his skin again and another lock of hair drops where Sinsong touches him. Grievance doubled, Eguzkilore throws a right-hook at the dwarf's jaw in the same breath: *"That's for leaving me bald."*
5. Nuberroca honours Sohey with a bottle of rum after the fight — a good one, he says, and he hopes one day to learn from him. The goblin receives it like a bar of gold — *"Where have you got this? I haven't tasted any in years!"* — downs half in one pull and hands it back; Nuberroca presses the full bottle on him. Willing to give something in return, Sohey draws out a small sealed ceramic jar like the ones the goblins had lobbed at Trepsin at range.
6. Mialee adds a box of carved figurines from her bag in tribute for the totem; Sohey weighs it at a glance and nods. His tribe has eyes in the trees, so he will come up there himself to fight the whole party when they are ready. He asks whether they know the magical stones for sending messages — he will use one to start the friendly duel. Then he turns and heads west toward the village.
7. Rejoining the others, Nuberroca turns the duel into a lecture — the fight was not a lesson for him, he says, but a lesson for them about how badly they cramp him by standing at his elbow in combat. He then channels his god's fury and his wounds start closing with a blue glow.

5 – Through the snow

~16:00, 17 Hammer 1490 DR

1. They set off back to the lodge along a faint trail. Mialee shows Nyx an area map she stole from Talis's meeting room. With the cartographer's tools from Nuberroca, Nyx takes point with a good heart.
2. The first hour reads easily; by about five the sun dips below the trees, and with it the cold creeps in and the snow begins to fall. Mialee wraps herself back into Nuberroca's furs; the southward trail still shows clearly enough for Nyx to follow.
3. The second hour is harder. Snow settles over the path and the way all but disappears; night presses in heavier, and even eyes used to the dark struggle against the blowing white. Nyx excuses her stumbles complaining that the blizzard is in her eyes; Kaelthar offers to turn back, but she waves him off and keeps her feet on what she can see.
4. By the third hour Eguzkilore suggests Kaelthar take wing and spot the lodge from above; Mialee counsels trust in Nyx instead. The halfling finds her own markers — branches she had broken on the way out — and walks them from one to the next until the lodge's cooking-smoke rises out of the pines ahead.

6 – Talis appears

~19:00, 17 Hammer 1490 DR

1. In the clearing outside the lodge the party settles their roles. Kaelthar will carry the totem forward as proof and announce the mission complete; Amidamaru hangs back well out of sight so that Trepsin's cloak stays unseen, and Mialee will not enter at all. Sinsong primes a touch of guiding magic to ride on Kaelthar when he starts talking.
2. A kobold spots them from the east and runs for the lodge; Nuberroca gives chase and finds more of them on that side of the house. Every kobold the party has seen here until now has been dressed for scrubbing pots; now they all carry steel. Through the walls, doors open and voices rise in what sound like orders.
3. Nuberroca argues for the back door and a pre-emptive knockout, but Mialee pushes for dialogue and nominates Sinsong to carry it. Before the cleric can decide how to call out, the front door opens — Talis steps out with Kushpia at her shoulder, and in the hall just behind them a pair of mercenaries wait with swords drawn. Talis asks what they are doing; Sinsong steps up: *"Talis — Nyx wanted a word with you."* Her own weapon stowed, Talis invites them in — provided they leave their arms outside.
4. Sinsong and Kaelthar step inside. Nyx will come only as far as the antechamber — she will not go farther unless Talis's people lay down their weapons too: *"No vamos a entrar aquí a que nos apuñalen."* Eguzkilore sighs and steps in beside her. Talis brings her fingers to her mouth, and whistles.

7 - Talis's whistle

~19:30, 17 Hammer 1490 DR

1. Crossbow bolts burst out of murder holes in the antechamber's east wall; one strikes Nyx deep in the ribs, another thumps into Eguzkilore. Talis raises a short wand and throws a mote of frost that swells into an ice-ball before it slams Kaelthar in the chest, cold crawling across his armour where it lands.
2. The two mercenaries — **Sorvic** and **Wessic** the Wizened, a grey-bearded old man with sixty hard years of war on him — drive forward and seize Kaelthar and Sinsong at the wrists. Sinsong lets himself be taken; Kaelthar tries to resist to no avail.
3. Nyx lifts her hand and casts a dome of silence on the far side of the hall — Talis's spoken words, and Sinsong's, both die inside it.
4. Eguzkilore's shot annihilates a kobold, leaving him nailed against the antechamber's west wall, feet off the ground. **Kushpia** cuts in at his back with her scimitar, managing only glancing hits.
5. From a woodpile in the east wing of the lodge, Mialee works arrows into Kushpia and vanishes into the shadows again. Beyond the east walls a new sound carries through: the unmistakable noise of a fight outside the lodge.
6. Nuberroca charges in yelling curses and lands a halberd-blow on Kushpia, avoiding vital points to keep her breathing. Kaelthar pivots in the grapple and breathes a cone of fire into three kobolds crowding the corner — two die on the spot with soundless screams, the third scuttles away burning; his follow-up spell dies in his throat in the silence.
7. Sinsong, bound to his party by shared sigils of peace, feels Nyx about to take Talis's magical spear through the chest and appears beside her at the moment of impact; the cold takes him in her stead and she stares, uncomprehending, at the empty air.
8. Mialee drives her short sword into Kushpia from behind and the cultist's eyes go out, scimitar bouncing uselessly off the elf's armour as she dies. Mialee then throws her dagger at Talis, but misses badly and the dagger bounces along the floorboards without a sound.
9. Nuberroca shoves Eguzkilore aside and closes on Talis: *"Talis! Drop your spear — hand it over and I'll spare your life."* He does not wait for a reply — his halberd bites deep into her flank and a shaft strike rounds it off.
10. Finding herself bleeding and ringed, Talis presses the spear tighter and steps a pace outside the silence to incant. Black motes stream from her mouth and bloom into a dense swarm of wasps that fills the chamber and blots out sight.
11. The swarm catches most of them, leaving Sinsong and Eguzkilore unconscious — the scar at the back of the dwarf's neck flashing for an instant; Mialee, Nuberroca and Kaelthar grind their teeth and endure the swarm while they can.
12. Talis breaks for the door — still bleeding from Nuberroca's wounds — but the swarm she conjured does not spare her, and she falls short of the door and does not rise. The wasps turn into mist as her soul abandons her body.
13. Rushing to her friend, Mialee drops one of Nyx's berries into Eguzkilore's mouth, waking him from the swarm's bite. From the east, the sound from the fight beside the lodge is redoubling.
14. ***[EPIC]*** Nuberroca changes the hold on his halberd and hurls it like a javelin at Sorvic across the room. The polearm punches clean through visor and skull both, throwing the mercenary through the stair railings and pinning him against the north wall.
15. In the same breath the barbarian stoops and takes up Talis's spear from where it has fallen — Dragongleam, the draconic-runed weapon she had reclaimed from him that morning, now back in his hands.

8 - Sinsong rises

1. The south window of the east wing bursts open in a cloud of glass shards, stone fragments and loose timber as a huge troll smashes out of the lodge and crashes onto Fenrir. A moment later Kaelthar feels the bond snap in his chest as the wolf dissipates into vapour; the troll is left stuck half-through the ruined opening, and from outside Mialee calls out: *"There's a huge troll out here!"*
2. Eguzkilore drags himself over to Sinsong, gives him one of the berries with a disgusted face, and finds a last breath in himself to get back to his feet.
3. ***[EPIC]*** Sinsong rises with a host of fey guardians. From beyond the murder holes grunts of pain carry back through the slits as the fey forms reach through to the guards on the other side. The cleric walks into the hall in the midst of the kobolds — eleven of them drop silently where he passes — Wessic, still on his feet, is left badly wounded. Sinsong throws himself behind the stairs to the second floor for cover.
4. As Nuberroca enters the main hall the two armour-suits flanking the door loose a freezing arc at him, he dodges it and finds Wessic still on his feet; a quick thrust with Dragongleam goes clean through him and the old veteran is left crushed, bleeding out on the floor.
5. In the antechamber Eguzkilore stands and shoots back through the murder-hole slits at the crossbowmen on the other side, leaving one of the guards close to death. Outside, Mialee cloaks her position in a thick mist of her own making and works another arrow into the troll still pinned at the breach.
6. As Nyx crosses into the main hall a cold blast hits her, the two gargoyle sentries peel from their pedestals, stone wings beating, and tear at her until she drops, only to fall themselves to the fey ethereal guardians.
7. A moment later Mialee, badly wounded, rushes into the hall shouting *"Troll!"* and is caught mid-word by an ice-blast in the doorway; she drops frozen on the threshold and her mist vanishes, revealing a huge troll a few steps from the entrance.

9 - Glass and stone

1. Nuberroca shoulders open the east door and comes in on the two guards readying their crossbows at the murder-hole slits. A brutal thrust with Dragongleam leaves the nearest in a heap on the floor; his comrade fires back and misses. An arrow from Eguzkilore finishes the last guard.
2. The troll crouches through the entrance into the antechamber — too big for the frame, stooped low at a doorway built for humans — and swings at Eguzkilore in the cramped space; the elf parries the stroke away with his sword. As it crosses into Sinsong's circle of fey guardians the spirits tear into it for a punishing wound on the way in.
3. On Nuberroca's left a second door explodes inward — splinters of timber spin through the room and a guard's corpse crushes under the weight as a third troll forces its shoulders through the splintered frame and reaches an arm at the goliath. Nuberroca twists clear of the grab; the troll pokes its head through for another clutch and finds only air.
4. Nuberroca disengages from the grabbing arm and closes on the crouched troll in front of Eguzkilore — the cold-rune statues at the inner door loose a freezing arc as he crosses, but he carries through the cold and drives Dragongleam into its flank in a reckless charge, following with a pommel-crack that leaves the beast bleeding profusely. Eguzkilore puts an arrow through it to finish it off, then lights a torch with a word of druid-magic and hurls it onto the body so the fire catches its hide and the troll will not rise again.
5. From the east a second troll comes up to the antechamber window, tears what is left of its frame away, and reaches through at Eguzkilore; most of the claws tear across the stonework, but one gash finds the elf.
6. Sinsong moves toward the troll in the eastern room, his fey guardians tearing at its flesh. The troll reaches for the dwarf and connects — but Kaelthar is pulled to Sinsong's side by the bond and takes the blow himself, dropping unconscious in his stead.
7. The dragonborn's sacrifice turns meaningless when a second strike from the troll drops Sinsong on the ground, the fey guardians fading away as the cleric falls. Nuberroca pours a potion down his throat and the cleric comes back to his senses a heartbeat after.
8. From the western corridor **Fenwick** the cook steps out at the head of a knot of kitchen staff, sharp blades in every hand, and calls across the ruined chamber: *"What the hell? Talis is dead? Get them!"* From the far side of the lodge, the sound of combat is clearly audible.